

Pokémon Depths — Game Design Brief

1. Concept

A roguelike dungeon-crawler spin-off of **Pokémon Rumble Run**, borrowing its overhead camera and its Pokémon Quest / Pokéball 3D models, but with **Pokémon Mystery Dungeon**-style procedurally generated floors instead of Rumble Run's fixed courses. Only Pokémon that have an existing Pokémon Quest model may appear anywhere in the game (starters, wild encounters, Rocket teams, Giovanni's team, legendaries).

2. Pre-Build Task: Quest Model Asset Catalog

Before implementation starts, once the full set of available Pokémon Quest models has been reviewed, build an **Excel spreadsheet** cataloging every Pokémon that has a Quest model, with columns for:

- **Evolution stage** (Basic / Stage 1 / Stage 2)
- **Evolves into** (which Pokémon, if any — only relevant if that evolution also has a Quest model)
- **Type(s)**
- **Starter-eligible** (yes/no — whether it can appear in the initial 3-choice starter selection)

This spreadsheet becomes the single source of truth the game logic pulls from (damage-by-stage, starter pool, catch pool, boss team generation, etc.).

3. Run Structure

- **Title Screen** → `Start Run` button
- **Starter Select**: offer 3 random starters drawn from a larger starter pool (Kanto, Johto, Hoenn, etc. trios)
- **5 floors per run**, each floor's theme randomly drawn (no repeats) from a **pool of 10 themes** (Section 10)
- Each floor ends in a **Team Rocket Grunt** standing on the up-stairs tile; bumping into them locks you into a forced battle

- Floor 5 (or a 6th “final” floor, TBD) is **Giovanni** — a fixed, harder capstone fight
- Run ends on victory over Giovanni, or on party wipe (permadeath model — confirm)

4. Camera, Controls, Exploration

- Overhead camera, matching Rumble Run
- Player controls their lead Pokémon directly through a 3D procedurally generated dungeon
- **Minimap** (top-left, always visible): fog-of-war style, fills in as you explore
- **Pause menu** (button top-right): opens a full, detailed floor map
- Difficulty ramps floor-to-floor (tougher grunt teams, more aggressive wild Pokémon, bigger layouts) but stays forgiving early on

5. Inventory / Bag Screen

- A **bag icon** sits directly beneath the minimap (top-left)
- Tapping it pauses gameplay and opens a dedicated **Inventory Screen**
- Layout:
 - Player’s **team of 6 Pokémon** displayed across the top
 - **Collected items** shown below in a stylized bag UI — a scrollable grid, **5 columns wide**, one item per slot

6. Glossary & Settings

- **Glossary button**: opens a reference screen listing every available power-up/item with a description of its effect (pulls from the Items / Power-Ups table)
- **Settings button**: opens a settings screen with independent volume sliders for **music** and **sound effects**
- *(Assumed placement: both accessible from the title screen, and also reachable from the in-run pause menu — confirm.)*

7. Team & Catching

- Max party size: **6 Pokémon**

- Wild Pokémon wander the floors in two flavors:
 - **Peaceful** — walking into one immediately starts the catch minigame
 - **Aggressive** (marked with a **purple aura/cloud**) — walking into one starts a forced battle first; winning unlocks the catch minigame
- **Catch minigame:** Pokémon GO-style — aim and throw a Quest-model Pokéball at the moving Quest-model Pokémon
- If the party is already full when a catch succeeds, prompt the player to swap in the new Pokémon or release it

8. Items / Power-Ups

Item	Effect
Rare Candy	Evolves an eligible party Pokémon on the spot
Oran Berry / Full Heal	Restores HP
Poké Ball / Great Ball / Ultra Ball	Used in the catch minigame; higher tiers = better odds
Town Map	Reveals the current floor's full layout on the minimap
Dowsing Machine	Reveals all item and wild-Pokémon locations on the current floor
X Attack	Temporary attack boost
Max Repel	Temporarily suppresses wild encounters
Escape Rope	Warps directly to the stairs
Revive	Auto-revives one fainted party member

(Starter set — trim or expand as needed.)

9. Combat

- Battles are **automatic** — Pokémon attack on their own once a battle starts (no manual move selection)
- Damage is based on evolution stage only:

Stage	Damage per hit
Basic (unevolved)	5
Stage 1	10
Stage 2	15
Legendary	20

- **Type effectiveness:** super-effective attacks get a damage bonus; resistances and immunities are ignored entirely (every hit lands at normal damage unless it's super effective)

10. Floor Theme Pool (pick 5 of 10 per run)

1. Verdant Forest — Grass / Bug
2. Rocky Cavern — Rock / Ground
3. Molten Caldera — Fire
4. Frozen Grotto — Ice
5. Tidepool Grotto — Water
6. Haunted Ruins — Ghost / Psychic
7. Rocket Warehouse — Electric / Steel / Poison (fits the Team Rocket theme)
8. Scorched Desert — Ground / Dark
9. Toxic Swamp — Poison
10. Crystal Caverns — Fairy / Rock

11. Floor Bosses

Floors 1–4 — Team Rocket Grunt

- 1 fixed "Team Rocket flavor" Pokémon (e.g. Weezing, Arbok, Muk, Golbat, Koffing, Raticate)
- Remaining team slots filled randomly, scaling in level/toughness with floor number

Final Floor — Giovanni

- Mewtwo (fixed)
- 1 random legendary
- 1 random legendary bird (Zapdos / Articuno / Moltres)
- 3 other random fully-evolved Pokémon
- (6 total)

12. Audio

Music pulled from *Pokémon Mystery Dungeon: Explorers of Sky* (user-supplied).

13. Target Platform & Hosting

- Built and optimized specifically for the **iPhone 16 Pro screen size**
- Layout must avoid any obstruction from the **Dynamic Island / notch** (top) or the **home indicator** (bottom) — all UI (minimap, bag icon, pause button, etc.) needs safe-area-aware positioning
- **Hosted on GitHub** (e.g. GitHub Pages)

14. Open Questions to Resolve Before Build

- **Tech stack**: what did Rumble Run use for the 3D models/camera (Three.js? Babylon.js? something else)? Pokémon Depths should match it.
 - Exact **super-effective damage multiplier** (e.g. $\times 1.5$ vs $\times 2$)
 - Catch-success formula: does ball tier affect odds numerically, or is it purely skill-based (aim/timing)?
 - **Permadeath** on party wipe, or does progress (Pokédex, unlocked starters) persist across runs?
 - Is Giovanni the 5th floor or a bonus 6th floor?
 - Any move variety per Pokémon, or is every attack a single generic “auto-attack” per the damage table above?
 - Exact touch control scheme for iPhone (virtual joystick vs. tap-to-move)
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This brief is meant to be handed to a build-focused Claude session to scope implementation.